

Planning the next few years of *All Saints' online*

A short briefing for our April 21 vestry meeting. One decision kit, three approvals.

Each section opens with the recommendation. The rest is there if you want it — you don't need it to vote.

I. Three directions. One decision.

Design

II. Platform — why Squarespace.

Tooling

III. Sign-up platform — recommendation.

Operations

IV. Timeline & budget.

Plan

Three directions. *One decision.*

We're picking a feeling, not a final pixel. Whichever direction we choose, we can refine the details. What we need today is a shared sense of how All Saints' should show up online.

See all three live: allsaints-redesign.nate-ernst7.workers.dev

The three at a glance

	OPTION 1 THE ORIGINAL	OPTION 2 THE SANCTUARY	OPTION 3 THE GATHERING
Feels like	A clean refresh of what we have	A beautiful Episcopal prayer book	A community you'd like to join
Leads with	Familiar structure, clean nav	Quiet beauty, stained glass, space	Real people, real moments, warm energy
Says about us	"We're organized and up-to-date."	"We're rooted, reverent, welcoming."	"We're alive, growing, glad you're here."
Best for visitors	Looking for information	Looking for reassurance	Looking for connection
Risk	Could feel safe but forgettable	Could feel formal if photos run thin	Could feel busy if photos crowd
Effort to maintain	Lowest	Medium	Medium

What changes, regardless

All three options share the same logo, colors, and fonts; the same service times, address, and clergy; **fewer menu items (5–6 instead of 10+)**; mobile-first design; real All Saints' photography; clear paths to give, watch live, and contact us; and a home for the Rector Search, weekly bulletin, and the Weekly Word. **The decision is about tone and structure, not what information we include.**

A leaning, not a verdict

All three are credible. Each says something true about us. The right answer is the one this vestry can stand behind together — there is no wrong choice in this room.

Where opinion has landed so far. When these were shown earlier, several members favored **Option 1 (The Original)** for its familiarity and low maintenance — a meaningful signal we should not dismiss. Others were drawn to **Option 2 (The Sanctuary)** for its quieter, more reverent tone.

If we don't reach consensus, my lean is Option 2 — The Sanctuary, for one reason worth saying plainly: a website is the first thing a curious newcomer or a discerning rector candidate sees. The Sanctuary's calm beauty answers the question *"is this a healthy parish?"* without saying a word, which matters during this in-between season.

The honest case for Option 1. It's the lowest-effort option to maintain, the most familiar to long-time members, and it carries the least risk if photography lags. If the vestry's collective gut is here, that's a defensible call.

The honest trade-off either way. Sanctuary leans on photography; Brian (Communications) will lead a 90-day photo refresh after launch. Original is safer but plainer — we trade interest for ease.

How we'll decide

1. Each member reviews the live URL before the meeting.
2. Brief walk-through of each option (~10 minutes).
3. Straw poll, discussion, decision. 30 minutes total.
4. Whichever direction we pick, colors, copy, and photos remain in our hands during the build.

Why *Squarespace*.

We're not picking a website. We're picking what the office and staff will live with for the next 5+ years. The platform decision is bigger than the design.

Recommendation

Squarespace, Business plan, billed annually with the nonprofit discount.

~\$248 the first year, ~\$276/year after that. All-in. No add-ons to chase, no specialist to hire.

Why this matters in plain terms

Our current site quietly creates work for whoever maintains it — small breakages, software pieces that need updating, a structure only one person fully understands. None of that is visible from the pew, but it adds up to hours and risk every month.

Squarespace is the all-in-one alternative most parishes our size land on. **One bill, one login, one place to learn.** If the person who maintains the site changes, the next person can be up to speed in an afternoon — not a search for a specialist.

The cost picture

Squarespace, year 1 (with nonprofit discount)	\$248
Squarespace, year 2 onward	~\$276 / year
Domain (allsaintsconcord.org — already ours)	unchanged
SignUpGenius (free tier)	\$0
Constant Contact (already paying)	unchanged
Current WordPress hosting & add-ons (we stop paying)	savings of a few hundred a year

Net: roughly cost-neutral compared to today — but we shed the ongoing maintenance burden and the risk of being one volunteer away from a stuck site.

Who handles the build

I'll handle it. Build, content, images, and the small technical pieces (giving widget, livestream, map, contact form) are all in scope and accounted for. Vestry doesn't need to source a developer or budget for

one. If you ever want a freelancer to take over later, Squarespace makes that straightforward — there's a published directory of them.

Sign-up platform — *recommendation.*

Today, parish sign-ups (Easter Flowers, Maundy Thursday Dinner, and the rest) live in scattered, ad-hoc pages. The new site needs one consistent place for them.

Recommendation

Use SignUpGenius. Start on the free tier. Upgrade to Starter (\$8.99/mo, ~\$108/year) only if we want custom branding.

The new website links out to SignUpGenius for any event with a sign-up. One pattern, one place to look, no surprises.

Why SignUpGenius

- **It's the standard for churches and schools.** Most parishioners have used it before — no learning curve.
- **The free tier is genuinely usable.** Unlimited sign-ups, unlimited participants, email reminders included.
- **Built for the right job.** Designed for slot-based coordination (bring a side dish, sign up for a vigil hour) — not just yes/no RSVPs.

How it shows up on the new site

One **"Events & Sign-ups"** page. Each event is a card with a date, a short description, and a "Sign up" button. When a sign-up closes, the card retires itself. This replaces the current "Sign Ups" menu, which today carries five seasonal entries that quickly go stale.

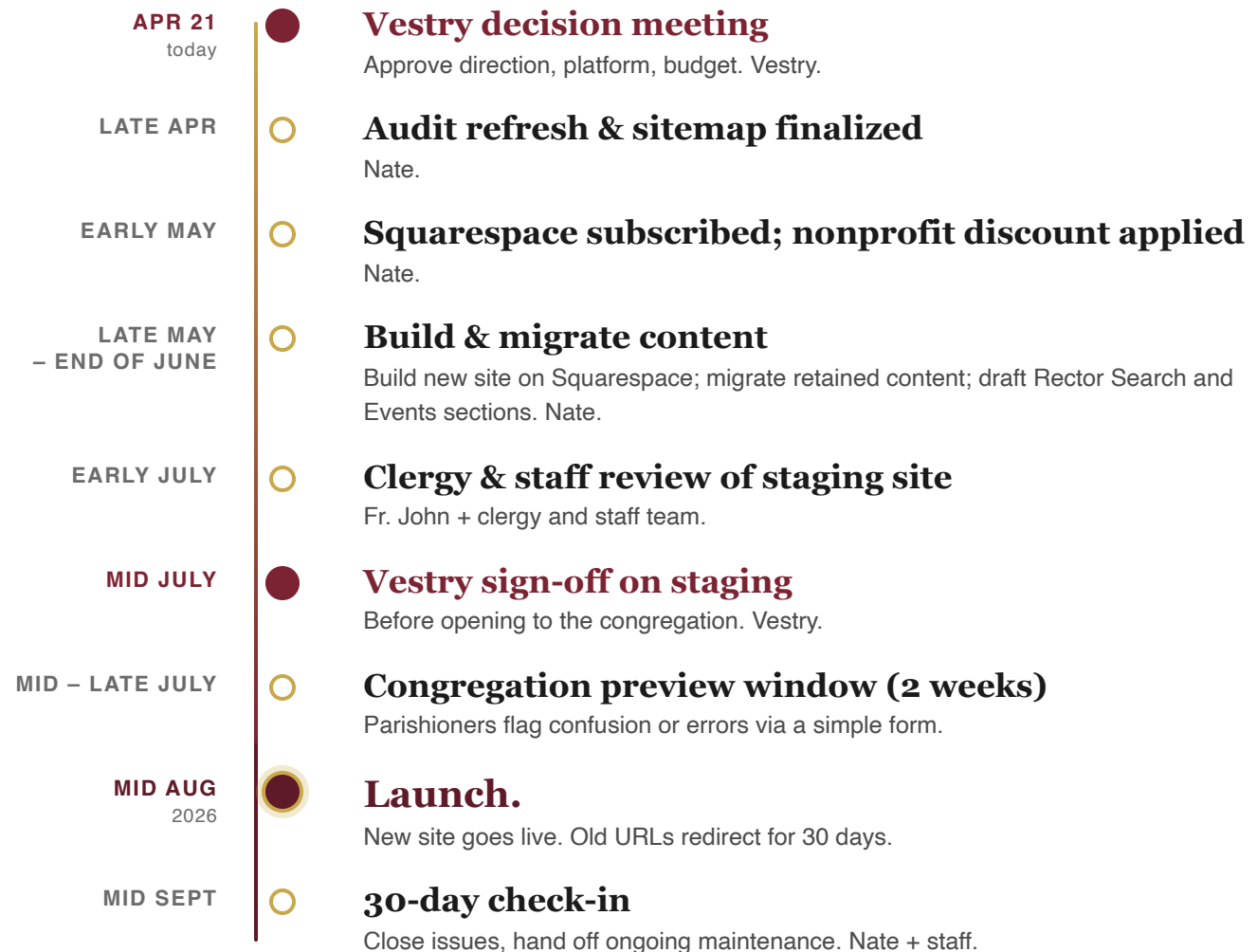
Whoever currently posts events on our site will continue to do so — the workflow is simpler, not harder.

What we need to decide today

One thing: approval to standardize on SignUpGenius for parish sign-ups going forward. Cost: \$0.
Risk: low. Reversible: yes.

Timeline at *a glance*.

From this meeting to a launched site in four months. Volunteer-paced, with deliberate buffer, three vestry checkpoints, and a calm summer build window before the program-year ramp-up.



○ Working milestone ● Vestry decision ● Launch

4 months from approval to live · 3 vestry decisions total

Timeline & *budget*.

Two questions in one document: when does this happen, and what does it cost?

Timeline

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER
Apr 21 — vestry meeting	Approve direction, platform, and budget	Vestry
Late Apr — mid May	Refresh content audit; finalize new sitemap	Nate
Late Apr — mid May	Subscribe to Squarespace; apply for nonprofit discount	Nate
Late May — end of June	Build the new site on Squarespace; migrate retained content	Nate
Early July	Clergy + staff review of staging site	Clergy + staff
Mid July	Vestry sign-off on staging site, before congregation preview	Vestry
Mid–late July	Congregation preview window: 2 weeks for feedback via simple form	Congregation
Early Aug	Incorporate feedback; final polish	Nate
Mid Aug 2026	Launch. Old URLs redirect for 30 days.	All
Mid Sept	30-day check-in; hand off ongoing maintenance	Nate + staff

Why mid-August. Calm summer build window, lands before the program-year ramp-up in September, no conflict with Holy Week or Easter prep.

What we are not doing. Not waiting for the new rector to launch. The Rector Search page is built to evolve; the new rector will shape welcome copy after they get to know us. Holding the website hostage to the search adds 3–6 months for no improvement.

Budget

YEAR-ONE COST	AMOUNT	NOTES
Squarespace Business plan	\$248	\$276 standard, less ~10% nonprofit discount
Domain (allsaintsconcord.org)	\$0	Free first year via Squarespace

YEAR-ONE COST	AMOUNT	NOTES
SignUpGenius	\$0	Free tier sufficient
Constant Contact (already paying)	unchanged	Weekly Word newsletter
Year-one total NEW spend	\$248	
Year-two and ongoing	~\$291/year	Squarespace + domain renewal
WordPress hosting + plugins (stopped)	savings \$200–400/yr	

Roles

Project owner	Nate Ernst	Drives work, coordinates, presents
Sponsor	Sr. Warden Chuck Collier	Speaks for the vestry
Clergy review	Fr. John + clergy team	Tone, theology, welcome copy
Communications	Brian Sapp-Moore + Ruth Brown	Photos, sign-ups, weekly bulletin link
Congregation	All members	Preview window feedback

Decision points (vestry asks)

The vestry will only be asked to make decisions at three moments:

1. **April 21 (today)** — direction, platform, and budget.
2. **Mid July** — sign-off on the staging site before congregation preview.
3. **Mid August** — final go/no-go on launch (consent only — assumed yes if no concerns).

Three meetings, three decisions. That's the vestry's whole role.

Three decisions. *One meeting.*

This kit asks the vestry to approve three things tonight. Together they give us a clear, modest, manageable path to launch by mid-August.

i.

Pick a direction

Original, Sanctuary, or Gathering. All three are credible — pick the one this vestry can stand behind together.

ii.

Approve the platform

Squarespace Business, ~\$248 first year, ~\$276/year after. Nonprofit discount applied.

iii.

Standardize sign-ups

SignUpGenius, free tier. One place for every event sign-up going forward.

"There is no perfect website. Only a next good one."